1951

F

FAR EASTERN DEPARTMENT

JAPAN

FJ 1022/90

221

FROM

Mr. Astor (The Observer)

To

Mr. Younger.

No.

Dated 10th February 1951.

Received in Registry— 21st February 1951

Requests that Mr. Younger grants an interview to Mr. O.M. Green re a talk on Japanese Peace Treaty: Object not to obtain views, but to procure material for a series of articles on Japan.

REFERENCES

MINUTES

(A) Foreign Office Minute (Mr. H. Scott) of 19th Feb.

IHM
22/2.

(B) Foreign Office Minute (Mr. C.P. Scott) of 19th Feb.

RBM
23/2

(Print)

(How disposed of)

(Action completed)

SH 23/2

(Index)

Kemp 21/6/51

39451

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(Action completed)

(Indexed)

MINUTES

(A) Foreign Office Minute (Mr. L.H. Scott) of 19th Feb.

I.T.M.
22/2.

(B) Foreign Office Minute (Mr. C.P. Scott) of 19th Feb.

R.B.M.
23/2

39451

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11.30 am Tue. 20-2

THE OBSERVER
·1791·
The Observer Limited
22 TUDOR STREET
LONDON, E.C.4

TELEPHONE:
CENTRAL 9481

FOREIGN OFFICE
12 FEB 1951
RECEIVED

222

10th February, 1951.

FJ 1022/90

Dear Kenneth Younger,

My most senior and august colleague, Mr. O.M. Green - who, as you may know, is a leading authority on Asia - has asked me to approach you with a request. He is anxious to talk to you about the present Japanese peace treaty negotiations. His object would not be to obtain any news from you - among all my colleagues, he is much the most high-minded and scrupulous in this matter of respecting confidences. What he wishes to know is the background of our policy in this subject. He will shortly be writing one or two articles on Japan and is keen to make sure that he knows all the considerations that should be borne in mind. If you are willing to see him, I shall be most grateful. I am sure that you would find him a satisfactory person to deal with. I should, by the way, warn you that he is slightly hard of hearing.

I spent the other evening with the Israeli Minister, Dr. Elath. He was, as you know, for long in Washington. I found him a man of Eban-calibre in intelligence and of more-than-Eban quality in cultural distinction. I think he would be most delighted if you cared to have an informal word with him sometime, but he is not likely to push himself before your attention.

Yours sincerely,

David Astor.

David Astor.

The Hon. K. G. Younger, M.P.,
FOREIGN OFFICE,
Downing Street, S.W. 1.

11.20 am
Tm 20-2

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Minister of State

FJ 1022/90 A

Public

F

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MR. O. GREEN OF THE "OBSERVER".

I return Mr. David Astor's letter of February 10th to you about Mr. O. Green who is calling to-morrow morning at 11.30 a.m. Mr. C.H. Johnston has already sent down the papers for which you asked.

2. I think you should know that Mr. O Green is not popular with the China and Korea Department as a result of an indiscretion of his a year ago. Since that time he has not been seen by the former Far Eastern Department and it may be for this reason that he is coming to see you and it may also be for this reason that Mr. Astor has pointedly drawn your attention to his high mindedness and scruples in respecting confidences.

3. In fact his reputation in respecting confidences is not very good and it would be as well, if you wish him not to quote you or not to use some of your remarks, to make this perfectly clear. He is very deaf and it may be that the occasional indiscretion which he commits is genuinely due to his not having heard whatever caution was given to him about using material. It seems odd that he seems to hear the substance of what is said to him but is apt to be deaf to the caution which sometimes accompanies the material.

4. I shall be coming down to be present as your Private Secretary has asked and if I may I shall come down two or three minutes before 11.30.

R. A. Butler

19th February, 1951.

Minister of State

FJ 1022/90 A

MR. O. GREEN OF THE "OBSERVER".

223

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Entire Minutes.

51022/903

(on sth and 7th)

I submit below two sets of the papers asked for by Mr. R.H. Scott on the 17th February, in connection with the interview which the Minister of State is consenting to give to Mr. O.M. Green of "The Observer".

2. It will be recalled that Mr. Green used to see Mr. Scarlett when he was Head of the Far Eastern Department, to receive regular background briefing on the Far Eastern questions. In February 1950 he came to see Mr. Shattock in the same way and on the same understanding. Having received a considerable amount of information in confidence at this interview, which was attended by Mr. Tomlinson, Mr. Green then published an article in which he attributed much of what he had been told "to a Foreign Office spokesman". As a result of this indiscretion, which must have been deliberate, Mr. Green has been refused the entrée to the Foreign Office since then and has only been seen by the News Department.

the Political Depts of

3. In all probability Mr. David Astor is not aware of the above and hence the third sentence of his letter to the Minister of State.

Copies of the attached note and papers have been sent direct to M.of S., who needed them urgently. But perhaps he should also be warned of the substance of the above remarks.

(O.P. Scott)
19th February, 1951

C.H. Johnston.

(A.C. Johnston.
19.ii.

Mr. R.H. Scott

Nothing to be Written in this Margin.

224

Eastern Minutes.

51022/90B

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(O.F. Scott)
19th February, 1951

C.H. Johnston.

(A.C. Johnston.
19.ii.

Mr. R.H. Scott

Nothing to be Written in this Margin.

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Nothing to be Written in this Margin.

Minutes.

225

Mr. R.H. Scott

Please see the attached letter from Mr. David Astor. The Minister of State, after consultation with the News Department, has agreed to see Mr. O.M. Green and an appointment has been fixed for 11.30 a.m. on Tuesday, February 20th. Unless you think it preferable, the Minister of State would not wish a special brief to be prepared for this interview, but would like to see any existing papers on the Japanese peace treaty negotiations which you may think useful to him. He would also be glad if you could be present when he receives Mr. Green.

D.J. Speares

(D.J. Speares)
16th February, 1951.

Mr C.H. Johnston

Please let me have the latest memorandum & the Cabinet papers & papers for Commonwealth PMs conference & I may like to see some time on Monday.

RHS

This is in addition to a short minute with enclosures which should go down with Minister on Monday.

Minute submitted.
C.H. Johnston 16.ii.

Nothing to be Written in this Margin.

Minutes.

225

Mr. R.H. Scott

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D.J. Speares

(D.J. Speares)
16th February, 1951.

Sir C.H. Johnston

Please call me when the latest memorandum & the Cabinet papers & briefs for Commonwealth PM's conference are ready for them in connection with Monday's meeting.

R.H.S.

17/2

This is in addition to a short minute with enclosures which should go down with the Minister on Monday.

Minute submitted.
C.H. Johnston 19.ii.

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JAPANESE PEACE TREATY: INTERVIEW WITH MR. P. M. GREEN

The following papers are submitted:

C.P.(50)323 - General paper on the Japanese Peace Treaty.

C.P.(50)322 - Individual claims against Japan.

C.P.(50)318 - Security aspects of the Japanese Peace Treaty.

P.M.M.(51)5 - Paper on the Japanese Peace Treaty, tabled at the Conference of Commonwealth Prime Ministers in January.

Memorandum dated 24th January on the Japanese Peace Treaty Conversations (FJ 1022/26).

2. The first three papers contain the policy of His Majesty's Government on the Japanese Peace Treaty and the fourth paper is a summary of C.P.(50)323 and C.P.(50)318.

3. Mr. Dulles began his talks in Tokyo with Sir A. Gascoigne and the Japanese Government a few days after the Memorandum of the 24th January was written. These talks showed a surprising degree of agreement between the views of His Majesty's Government and those of the State Department. The only two points of real difficulty (apart from the connected but distinct problem of Pacific Defence) will probably be, (a) the question of Chinese participation, and (b) the disposal of Formosa. Both these will require careful handling if serious Anglo/United States disagreement is to be avoided. On this aspect of the Treaty it would be helpful if comment and publicity could be kept to the minimum, since we are only likely to get a working arrangement with the Americans if we can speak plainly and in private.

4. The United States Government wish to negotiate a Japanese Peace Treaty as far as is possible through the diplomatic channel and wish the Peace Conference to be a formal meeting at which an already agreed draft will be signed. Mr. Dulles hopes that a Treaty can be signed "by mid-1951" or the early autumn. We have no official confirmation of this from the United States Government. It may be, however, that it will be difficult to follow this course if it is desired that as many as possible of the forty-nine States at war with Japan should accede to the Peace Treaty. All the belligerents will probably press for their views to be taken into account at some stage; in the past this has normally been done at the Peace Conference. It is probable that United States policy on this question is not yet settled; meanwhile it would be helpful if, here too, comment and publicity could be avoided.

5. The following paragraphs of the papers mentioned in paragraph 1 seem the most important:

C.P.(50)323 - Paragraph 8.

C.P.(50)322 - The whole of the Secretary of State's Memorandum.

C.P.(50)318 - Paragraphs 6 to 10, 15, 16 and 19 to 23.
(Note: Mr. Dulles has accepted these Conclusions, his only comment being that he doubted the advisability of requiring Japan, under a Defence Agreement, to build up armed forces.)

/ P.M.M.(51)5

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(Note: Mr. Dulles has accepted these Conclusions, his only comment being that he doubted the advisability of requiring Japan, under a Defence Agreement, to build up armed forces.)

/ P.M.M.(51)5

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END.

P.M.M.(51)5 - Paragraphs 2 and 3, 8 and 9, 14 to 16.

The Memorandum of the 24th January may be read in full, although paragraphs 6 and 12 to 17 seem the most important.

A copy of the above minute has been submitted to Mr. R.H. Scott.

C.H. Johnston.

(C.H. Johnston)
19th February, 1951.

227
END.

P.M.M.(51)5 - Paragraphs 2 and 3, 8 and 9, 14 to 16.

The Memorandum of the 24th January may be read in full, although paragraphs 6 and 12 to 17 seem the most important.

A copy of the above minute has been submitted to Mr. R.H. Scott.

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